

Tasin Academy

Opposite Of Alekanda Govt College, Barishal

Phone: 01722335722

(Unit – 11, Lesson – 2B)

An old man with steel-rimmed spectacles and very dusty clothes sat by the side of the road. There was a pontoon bridge across the river and carts, trucks, and men, women and children were crossing it. The mule-drawn carts staggered up the steep bank from the bridge with soldiers helping push against the spokes of the wheels. The trucks ground up and away heading out of it all and the peasants plodded along in the ankle deep dust. But the old man sat there without moving. He was too tired to go any farther.

It was my business to cross the bridge, explore the bridgehead beyond and find out to what point the enemy had advanced. I did this and returned over the bridge. There were not so many carts now and very few people on foot, but the old man was still there.

“Where do you come from?” I asked him.

“From San Carlos,” he said, and smiled.

That was his native town and so it gave him pleasure to mention it and he smiled.

“I was taking care of animals,” he explained.

“Oh,” I said, not quite understanding.

“Yes,” he said, “I stayed, you see, taking care of animals. I was the last one to leave the town of San Carlos.”

He did not look like a shepherd nor a herdsman and I looked at his black dusty clothes and his gray dusty face and his steel rimmed spectacles and said, “What animals were they?”

“There were three animals altogether,” he explained. “There were two goats and a cat and then there were four pairs of pigeons.”

1A. Multiple Choice Questions

1. **What was the old man wearing?**
 - i) A uniform and boots
 - ii) Dusty clothes and spectacles
 - iii) Black coat and hat
 - iv) New clothes and sandals
2. **Why was there a pontoon bridge?**
 - i) It was a market area
 - ii) The main bridge was broken
 - iii) Soldiers were retreating
 - iv) To help people cross during war
3. **What was the narrator’s task?**
 - i) To help the old man
 - ii) To inspect the enemy's advancement
 - iii) To guard the bridge
 - iv) To lead the villagers
4. **Why was the old man unable to move?**
 - i) He was wounded
 - ii) He had no transport
 - iii) He was tired
 - iv) He was waiting for someone
5. **What animals did the old man mention?**
 - i) Dogs and goats
 - ii) Goats, a cat, and pigeons
 - iii) Horses and cows
 - iv) Cats and rabbits

1B. Short Questions

- a) Where was the old man sitting and in what condition?
- b) What made the old man happy when he spoke of San Carlos?
- c) What was happening on the bridge during the war?
- d) Why did the narrator speak to the old man?
- e) How did the old man describe the animals?

2. Table Completion

What/Who	Event/Description	What/Where	When/How
The old man	Sitting by the road	Near a (i) ----- bridge	During wartime
People	Crossing with carts and luggage	With (ii) —— help	Slowly and in dust
Narrator	Explored the (iii) -----	Returned back	After checking enemy movement
Old man	Came from San Carlos	Felt (iv) —— about it	When asked
Old man's duty	Taking care of (v) -----	Back in San Carlos	Before evacuation
The animals	Included two goats and a (vi) -----	Also had (vii) -----pigeons	Left behind
Old man's appearance	Dusty face, (viii) —— spectacles	Sat by the road	Unmoving due to tiredness
The peasants	Plodded along the road	Covered in (ix) -----	With their belongings
Soldiers	Helped push the (x) —— carts	Uphill from the bridge	With effort

3. Summary Writing

Write a summary of the passage in your own words. Focus on the old man, his background, and the situation on the bridge during wartime.

_____ **Best Of Luck** _____